

Chapter 43-3

//

Xu Qingzhu was in a bad mood and was too lazy to continue shopping in the afternoon. Cherry had something at home and left early.

Sally wanted to go dancing and insisted on dragging Xu Qingzhu along, but Xu Qingzhu politely declined.

In the end, Sally had to go alone.

Xu Qingzhu went to another mall to look at the current jewelry designs on the market.

BARE also made jewelry, but it wasn't their main focus - they were more into clothes and bags. In the industry, Minghui's biggest competitor was Haiwei Jewelry¹, mainly because their design styles were novel each year, and they kept surpassing themselves every year.

In today's society where a hundred flowers bloom, being able to maintain such strong creativity year after year was a rare thing.

Haiwei Jewelry's main designer was very mysterious, never appearing in public, never participating in any design competitions. Each year's signature was only one letter: Q.

Even the internal employees at Haiwei Jewelry didn't know who Q was.

After all, this person worked from home.

This mysterious designer had caused quite a stir in the industry. Some said it was Su Yao, who had once been at the height of fame but disappeared during her peak years. Others said it was a gifted person with social anxiety. Still others claimed it was the famous designer Cen Jing, who had withdrawn from the design world due to depression.

In any case, there were various theories, none of them reliable.

The media had also tried to investigate, but General Manager Su of Haiwei Jewelry protected this person extremely well.

They couldn't dig up any information at all.

However, most people leaned toward it being Su Yao.

After all—they both had the surname Su.

But some also said that Su Yao had died of grief not long after her boyfriend Sheng Qinglin died in a car accident back then.

The rumors were mixed with truth and falsehood, and Xu Qingzhu didn't know what to believe.

Even though one of her uncles whom she'd never met was involved in this gossip.

Some people even said she wasn't her parents' biological daughter.

People in this circle loved to gossip. Everyone's business could be discussed and spread around seven or eight times, causing these stories to lose their original truth.

Xu Qingzhu had never believed any of it anyway.

She and Xu Qingya looked so much alike.

And her parents treated her extremely well.

She had also seen photos of her uncle at home - he was very handsome, much better looking than current male celebrities.

He resembled her mother by seventy percent, but with more masculine features.

A genius youth who died young.

Xu Qingzhu had also felt sorry for him. When she was little and went with her parents to visit his grave, looking at his photo, her mother would always cry endlessly.

She didn't feel much.

Probably because they had never spent time together.

However, Haiwei Jewelry wasn't just special in design style - their choice of materials and yearly marketing were also excellent.

For a company to reach the position of industry leader, it must have advantages in all aspects.

Xu Qingzhu browsed at the specialty counters for a long time, looking at several stores. After finishing, she went to the restroom, planning to leave the mall and go home.

But as soon as she came out of the restroom, she felt a gust of wind pass by her, and her shoulder hurt.

A man had grabbed the bag from her shoulder and ran off.

In broad daylight...

Robbery...

Xu Qingzhu felt like she might not have checked the almanac before leaving home today.

And it also fulfilled that saying: "Good fortune never comes in pairs, misfortune never comes alone."²

She shouted while chasing: "Robbery!"

And rolled up her sleeves to chase after the person.

That person might have practiced sprinting - he was extremely fast, like a cheetah. When people were caught off guard, he directly knocked through the crowd, weaving through the masses with ease, racing toward the entrance.

A crowd of people were all stunned, no one helped chase, and no one even tried to block him.

Xu Qingzhu shouted loudly: "That person is a robber!"

She had no talent in sports - during school, her physical tests had almost never passed. There was no way she could catch up, so she took out her phone to call the police.

But then a little girl in a lolita dress³ appeared. When the man was almost at the entrance, as he passed by her, the little girl stuck out her foot in red leather shoes and directly tripped the man.

Then the security guards at the entrance finally reacted, and three or five people rushed up to pin the man to the ground.

When Xu Qingzhu arrived, the girl in the lolita dress was holding her bag, looking down at her phone, and without even raising her head said: "Here, check if anything's missing inside."

Xu Qingzhu was panting from running, casually checked through her bag - nothing was missing.

She was particularly puzzled and walked over to ask the pinned man: "What were you thinking? In such a big mall, did you think you could actually escape?"

The man was quite stubborn and turned his head away, ignoring her.

Xu Qingzhu: "..."

An onlooker had called the police. When the police arrived and saw this person, they discovered he was a repeat offender.

After taking Xu Qingzhu's statement and confirming a few details, they took the man away, and this farce finally came to an end.

Xu Qingzhu thanked the little girl: "Thank you."

She took out five hundred yuan from her wallet and handed it over.

The little girl waved her hand to refuse, finally willing to lift her head from her mobile game, looked up and said in surprise: "Xu... Xu Qingzhu?"

Xu Qingzhu also felt the little girl looked familiar but couldn't remember where she'd seen her.

It wasn't until she introduced herself: "Hello, I'm Su Meiqi. I met you before when I was with Lin Xingcan."

"With... together?" Xu Qingzhu was surprised.

"We were friends," Su Meiqi also realized her wording was misleading and immediately corrected herself, "We used to be friends."

This statement made people can't help but ask: "What about now?"

Su Meiqi paused: "We broke off our friendship."

Xu Qingzhu: "..."

She looked at Su Meiqi, feeling quite a sense of "fellow sufferers," so she asked: "Would you like me to treat you to some orange juice?"

Su Meiqi put away her phone: "Sure."

Footnotes:

¹ Haiwei Jewelry: A fictional high-end jewelry company name (海薇珠宝)

² "Good fortune never comes in pairs, misfortune never comes alone": A Chinese idiom meaning that good things rarely happen together, but bad things often come one after another

³ Lolita dress: A fashion style originating from Japan, characterized by elaborate, doll-like dresses with frills and bows